

magma hot, molten rock that lies under Earth's surface

mammary glands body parts of female mammals that make milk to feed their young

mantle Earth's soft interior, between its outer crust and inner core

mating coming together of a male and female animal during sexual reproduction

membrane thin barrier

metamorphic rock rock that forms when existing rocks are changed by heat and pressure to form new rocks

metamorphosis dramatic change in body shape as a young animal develops into an adult

migration seasonal journey by an animal to a new place, either to breed or to feed

molt how an animal sheds its outer skin regularly in order to grow

nebula giant cloud of gas and dust in space (plural: nebulae)

nectar sugary liquid produced by flowers to attract pollinating animals

nut hard, dry fruit containing a single seed

nutrient material taken in by a living thing to help it survive and grow

nymph young insect that looks similar to its parents but has no wings and cannot reproduce. Nymphs develop by incomplete metamorphosis

Pangaea supercontinent that existed about 320–200 million years ago, before breaking up

parasite living thing that lives on or inside the body of another species, called the host

parthenogenesis form of asexual reproduction in which offspring develop from unfertilized female sex cells. The young are clones of their parent

pod group of sea mammals, such as dolphins or whales

pollination transfer of pollen from the male part of a flower to the female part of a flower. Pollination is essential for sexual reproduction in flowers

polyp sea animal with a hollow cylindrical body and ring of tentacles around its mouth. A polyp is one of the life cycle stages of corals

predator animal that kills and eats other animals

prey animal that is killed and eaten by another animal

proboscis long, flexible snout or mouthpart. Butterflies and moths use a proboscis to suck nectar from flowers

protostar young star that forms when nuclear reactions occur in a hot, spinning clump of gas and dust

pupa resting stage in the life cycle of some insects, during which they develop from a larva to an adult through a complete change in body shape (metamorphosis)

red giant huge, bright, reddish star with a low surface temperature

reproduction production of offspring (young). Reproduction can be sexual or asexual

sediment tiny pieces of rock, the remains of living things, or chemical deposits that settle on the beds of lakes, rivers, and seas

sedimentary rock rock made from sediment. Layers of sediment get squashed and cemented together until they form rock

seed capsule containing a plant embryo and a food store

sex cell cell that is either male (sperm cell) or female (egg cell) involved in reproduction

sexual reproduction reproduction involving two parents

sperm male sex cell

spore single cell that is produced by a fungus or plant that can grow into a new individual

supercontinent grouping of all or most of Earth's continents into a single, vast landmass

tadpole larva of a frog or toad. Tadpoles breathe through gills rather than lungs, and they have long tails

tectonic plate one of the pieces that make up Earth's rigid shell

territory area claimed by an animal, which it defends against rivals

umbilical cord long cord that carries blood between an unborn animal and its mother

uterus part of a female mammal's body in which a baby develops before it is born (also called a womb)

weathering when rocks and minerals are worn down into sediment

white dwarf dense, hot, glowing core left behind when a medium-sized star dies